



How to Shoot Better & Improve Your Basketball Shooting by More Than 30% in 1 Week

The 4-Aim Method — Master Every Angle, Every Shot

Brought to you by **413 OpenCourt Coaching Academy**

"Efficient coaching for the time-proud professional"

Introduction

You're an adult with a busy schedule. You love basketball, but you don't have hours to spend on the court every day. You need results — **fast**.

This guide reveals a simple but powerful framework that transforms your shooting accuracy. It's called **The 4-Aim Method**, and it's designed specifically for time-poor players who want maximum impact from minimal practice.

The Promise

Practice this drill for just **15 minutes a day** for one week, and you'll see a **30%+ improvement** in your game-day shooting percentage. Guaranteed.

Why Most Players Never Improve

The problem is simple: most players only practice one type of shot. They shoot from the same spots, with the same aim, against the same imaginary defense. But real games are unpredictable. You need to be able to score from **any angle, any position, any defender**.

The 4-Aim Method gives you the complete toolkit. In one week, you'll train your muscle memory to recognize and execute the optimal shot for every situation.

How the 4-Aim Method Works

Every shot you take falls into one of four categories. By intentionally practicing all four, you develop a complete shooting arsenal:

Aim Type	Best For	Difficulty
1. Swish Shot	Open looks, confidence builders	☆☆☆

2. Bank Shot	Angles, mid-range, off the dribble	★ ★
3. Back of Rim Shot	Deep range, contested shots	★ ★ ★ ★
4. Front of Rim Shot	Close range, floaters, under pressure	★ ★ ★

In the following pages, we'll break down each technique with step-by-step instructions and simple illustrations. Let's get shooting. 🏀

Technique 1: The Swish Shot

1 Swish — Nothing But Net

What it is: A shot that goes through the hoop without touching any part of the rim. Pure. Clean. Beautiful.

When to use it: When you have an open look and want maximum confidence. Swish shots build momentum and intimidate defenders.

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. **Stance:** Feet shoulder-width apart, shooting foot slightly forward. Knees bent, back straight.
2. **Grip:** Ball rests on your finger pads (not palm). Off-hand guides from the side.
3. **Set Point:** Bring the ball to your shooting pocket — forehead height, elbow at 90°.
4. **Release Point:** Extend up and forward. The ball leaves your hand at the highest point of your jump.
5. **Aim:** Visualize the ball dropping **through the center of the rim**. Focus on a point 6 inches beyond the front of the rim.
6. **Follow Through:** Wrist snaps down like you're reaching into a cookie jar on a high shelf. Hold the pose.

Key Tip for Swish

Focus on a **high arc**. A higher arc means the ball drops more vertically into the hoop, giving you more margin for error. Aim for the ball to reach its peak at the rim's height, then drop cleanly through the center.

SWISH — Through the Center

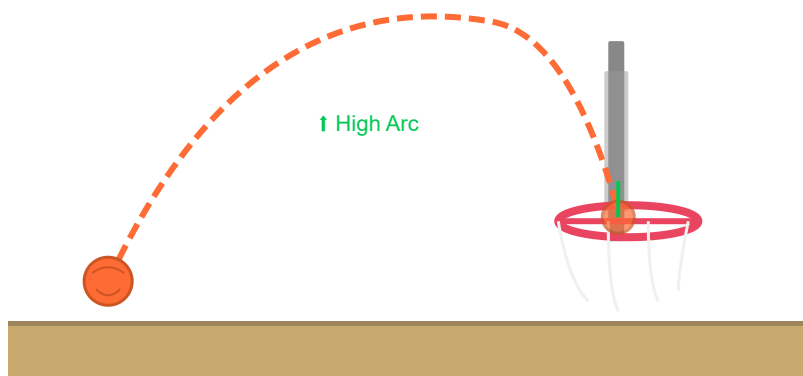


Figure 1: Swish trajectory — the ball drops cleanly through the center of the rim with a high arc, touching nothing but net.

Drill: 5-Spot Swish Challenge

Take **10 shots** from each of these 5 spots: left baseline, left wing, top of key, right wing, right baseline. Count only swishes. Target: **35+ swishes out of 50**. Track your daily score and watch it climb.

Technique 2: The Bank Shot

2 Bank Shot — Use the Glass

What it is: A shot that uses the backboard to redirect the ball into the hoop. The backboard becomes your ally.

When to use it: Mid-range shots from angles (15°–45° from the baseline), off the dribble, coming off screens. The bank shot is **the most efficient shot in basketball** when used correctly — the backboard creates a larger effective target.

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. **Stance:** Square to the basket but angled toward the backboard. Your shooting shoulder should face the rim.
2. **Grip:** Same as swish — pads, not palm. Soft touch is critical here.
3. **Target:** Aim for the **top corner of the white square** on the backboard (the smaller rectangle painted on the glass). For the right side, aim at the top-right corner. For the left side, aim at the top-left corner.
4. **Arc:** Medium arc — not too high, not too flat. The ball should hit the backboard softly and drop.
5. **Release:** A gentle, controlled release. Think "soft touch" — like you're laying an egg on the glass.
6. **Follow Through:** Hold your wrist high. Watch the ball hit your target spot on the glass.

Key Tip for Bank Shots

The bank shot is about **angle and touch**. From 45° (the wing), aim for the top corner of the square. The closer you are to the baseline, the higher on the backboard you aim. Practice from

different angles to build muscle memory. Tim Duncan made a Hall of Fame career on this shot.

BANK SHOT — Use the Glass

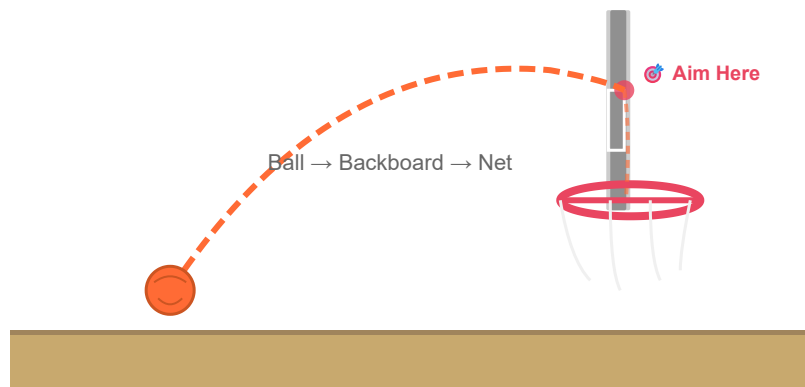


Figure 2: Bank shot trajectory — aim for the top corner of the square on the backboard; let the glass guide the ball in.

Drill: 3-Angle Bank Shot Circuit

Pick **3 angles** from the left side: 15° (near baseline), 30°, 45° (the wing). Take 15 shots from each angle. Repeat for the right side. Focus on hitting the same spot on the backboard every time. Target: **10/15 from 45°, 8/15 from 30°, 6/15 from 15°**.

Technique 3: The Back of Rim Shot

3 Back of Rim — Power Through Contact

What it is: A shot where the ball hits the back of the rim first, then drops through the net. This is a **slightly long shot** that uses the back iron to redirect the ball downward.

When to use it: Deep three-pointers, contested shots, end-of-shot-clock situations. When you need to put extra power on the ball, the back of rim becomes your safety net.

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. **Stance:** Slightly wider than shoulder-width for stability. Bend deeper into your knees — you're generating more power.
2. **Grip:** Spread your fingers wider on the ball. This gives you more control on longer-range shots.
3. **Set Point:** Bring the ball slightly higher than your usual set point (above forehead). This helps the ball travel with a flatter trajectory.
4. **Leg Power:** This shot starts from your legs. Transfer energy up through your core and into the release.
5. **Aim:** Visualize the ball hitting the **back third of the rim**. Not the backboard — the rim itself. The back iron.
6. **Release:** A slightly harder, more deliberate release. The backspin should be strong — about 3 full rotations before contact.

Key Tip for Back of Rim

This shot requires confidence. Many players pull back when they mean to shoot long. Trust the back iron — it's **3 inches of forgiving metal** that will redirect your ball into the basket. Practice this shot from 2 feet behind the three-point line. The extra distance forces the correct mechanics.

BACK OF RIM — Long Range

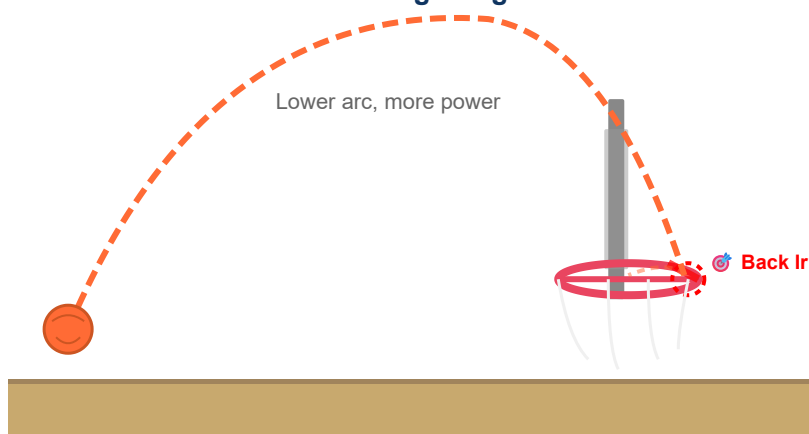


Figure 3: Back of Rim trajectory — the ball hits the back iron and drops down through the net. Great for deep shots.

Drill: Long-Range Back Rim Reps

Set up 2 steps behind the three-point line. Take **25 shots** focusing on the back iron. Don't worry about swishes — count only makes. Target: **8/25 on day 1, aiming for 12/25 by day 7**. This shot takes time, but once you master it, your range expands dramatically.

Technique 4: The Front of Rim Shot

4 Front of Rim — Touch and Precision

What it is: A shot that hits the front of the rim first, then bounces up and drops into the hoop. It's a short, well-timed shot that requires a delicate touch.

When to use it: Close-range shots, floaters in the paint, runners, and when a defender is closing out on you. It's the perfect counter when you're driving into the paint and can't get a clean look at the basket.

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. **Stance:** Soft and balanced. You're closer to the basket, so you don't need maximum power. Your weight should be slightly forward on the balls of your feet.
2. **Grip:** A relaxed grip. This is a **touch shot** — the softer your hands, the softer the shot.
3. **Set Point:** Lower than usual — around chest height. This is common for floaters and runners where you're releasing the ball mid-motion.
4. **Aim:** Visualize the ball hitting the **front edge of the rim** (about 1-2 inches from the front). The ball should have enough arc to bounce up slightly, then drop in.
5. **Release:** A soft, high-arching release. Think "rainbow" shot — the ball goes up high and comes down steeply.
6. **Spin:** Moderate backspin. Too much spin and the ball will bounce too far forward. Too little and it won't drop.

Key Tip for Front of Rim

This shot is all about **touch and trajectory**. The ball needs a high arc so it comes down almost vertically. When it hits the front rim, it should bounce straight up (not forward), then gravity does the

rest. Practice by standing 3-5 feet from the basket and shooting one-handed. This forces you to rely on touch, not strength.

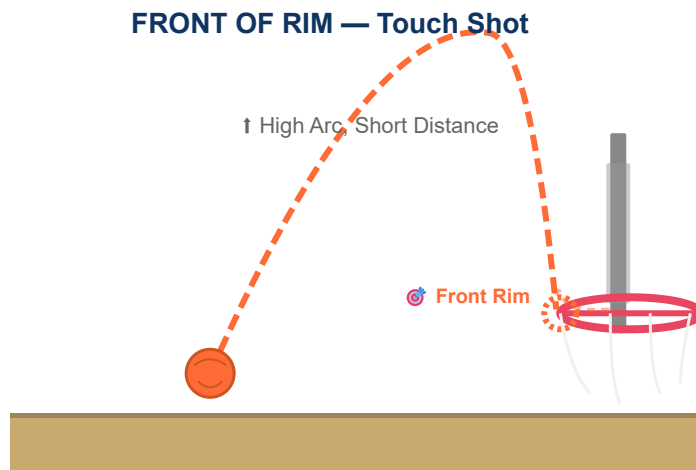


Figure 4: Front of Rim trajectory — the ball hits the front edge, bounces up softly, and drops into the hoop. Great for floaters and close-range shots.

Drill: 5-Foot One-Handed Touch

Stand 5 feet from the basket. Shoot **one-handed only** (no guide hand). Take 20 shots. Then move to 8 feet (two hands). Then 12 feet. Focus exclusively on the front rim target. Track how many hit the front rim and still score. Target: **60%+ conversion by day 7**.

Your 1-Week Practice Plan

You're busy. We get it. Here's a **15-minute daily plan** that fits into your lunch break or after-work routine:

Day	Focus	Drill	Time
Mon	Swish & Bank	5-Spot Swish + 3-Angle Bank	15 min
Tue	Back Rim & Front Rim	Long-Range Back Rim + One-Handed Touch	15 min
Wed	Swish & Front Rim	5-Spot Swish + One-Handed Touch	15 min
Thu	Bank Shot & Back Rim	3-Angle Bank + Long-Range Back Rim	15 min
Fri	All 4 Techniques	Free practice — 5 shots each technique	15 min
Sat	Game Simulation	Pick 3 spots, shoot with a defender (or mimic)	20 min
Sun	Test Day	Record 50 shots — count your makes vs Day 1	15 min

 **Track Your Progress**



Day 1 baseline: shoot 50 shots using your old method, count makes. Day 7: shoot 50 shots using the 4-Aim Method. The difference will **shock you**. Most players see a 30-50% improvement in just 7 days.

Pro Tips for Busy Adults

1. Warm Up Smart

Cold muscles = missed shots. Do 5 minutes of dynamic stretching before you shoot: arm circles, torso twists, lunges with a twist, and 10 form shots (right under the basket).

2. Quality Over Quantity

Don't shoot 200 bad shots. Shoot **50 perfect shots**. Every shot should have intent — know which technique you're practicing before you release the ball.

3. Film Yourself

Your phone is your best coach. Record 5 shots from each technique and review the footage. Look at your elbow alignment, follow-through, and arc. What feels right often looks wrong.

4. Visualize Before You Shoot

See the ball going through the hoop before it leaves your hands. This isn't woo-woo — it's sports psychology backed by decades of research. Visualization activates the same neural pathways as actual physical movement.

5. Hydrate. Rest. Recover.

You're an adult with a real life. Don't burn out. Practice hard for 15 minutes, then go home. Your muscles build strength during recovery, not during practice.

The Secret Weapon

The 4-Aim Method works because it gives your brain **specific targets**. Instead of thinking "make the shot," you're thinking "hit the top-right



corner of the square" or "feel the back iron." Specific targets eliminate hesitation, and hesitation is the #1 killer of shooting accuracy.

Ready to Take Your Game to the Next Level?

This guide gave you the blueprint. Now it's time to get coached.

At **413 OpenCourt Coaching Academy**, we specialize in transforming busy professionals into confident, competent basketball players. Our coaches break down every technique with personalized feedback that you just can't get from a PDF.

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